

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 9 8 6 4

♥ 9 5 3

♦ 10

♣ J 8 6 3

♠ A

♥ J 7 4

♦ A K J 9 7 5

♣ A 7 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 10 7 3

♥ K Q 10 6

♦ 3 2

♣ 10 9 5

♠ Q 5 2

♥ A 8 2

♦ Q 8 6 4

♣ K Q 2

West

North

East

South

1♦

Pass

2NT

Pass

4♦

Pass

5♦

Pass

6♦

All Pass

6♦ by North

Lead: ♥K

North is to play 6♦. East leads the ♥K.

You have 11 winners; 1 ♠, 1 ♥, 6 ♦s and 3 ♣s.

At first things look hopeless, but remember this is a lesson on squeeze plays. From the opening lead you know that East must hold the ♥Q. If he also holds the ♠K you will be able to squeeze him in ♥s and ♠s.

You let the ♥K win, (hoping he will play another ♥), but he plays a small trump instead which you win in your hand.

Pull one more round of trumps, then unblock the ♠A.

Then take your 3 ♣ winners, ending in your hand.

Now play ♦Q, ♦J, ♦9. Discard the ♠5 from dummy on the third ♦.

East could afford to throw 2 ♠s and a ♥ on your ♦ plays.

But when you play the ♦7 he is squeezed.

He cannot dump his ♠K because you would throw the ♥8 and dummy would be high.

So he will discard the ♥10 instead. At this point you know that the ♠Q is worthless so you discard it. You win the final two tricks with the ♥A and ♥J.

Board 2

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 6 5 4 2
♥ J
♦ 9 8 4 3
♣ J 10 9 3

♠ A K J

♥ K 7 3

♦ A 6 5 2

♣ 8 6 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 10 9 3

♥ 10 5 4

♦ K J 10

♣ A K Q

♠ 8 7

♥ A Q 9 8 6 2

♦ Q 7

♣ 7 5 2

West

North

East

South

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

Lead: ♣J

1NT

2♥

South is to play 4♥. West leads the ♣J. East wins ♣ A K Q then switches to a trump.

East takes ♣ A K Q then switches to a trump.

You must win the next 10 tricks but you only have 9 winners.

East opened 1NT, showing 15-17 points, and West has already produced 2 Jacks. So both the ♠Q and ♦K are with East and you will have to put the squeeze on him.

You are in dummy, having won their trump exit with the ♥K.

Since you need all the tricks the count is already rectified.

You plan to squeeze East by running the long ♥s in your hand, but the problem is that the ♦Q is not a Threat card yet. To make it a Threat you need to unblock dummy's ♦A. So play the ♦A, then pull trumps with the ♥A Q.

Unblocking the ♦A to make your ♦Q a squeeze Threat is called the Vienna Coup.

With 6 cards left to be played you are ready to apply pressure to East.

Play the ♥9 8, discarding ♦s from dummy. East is not troubled yet, he can discard the ♦J and the ♠3.

East is now looking a little nervous, like he has a big target on his back!

Play the ♥6 and throw dummy's ♦6.

East can choose his fate. If he throws the ♠9 you will know that his ♠Q will drop since his third card **MUST** be the ♦K. So you would just play to the high ♠s and the ♠J would be good.

Or, he can throw his ♦K which makes your ♦Q a winner.

That worked great, right? Let's back up and pretend you had NOT unblocked the ♦A. We will just add one ♦ to everybody's hand and look at the ending.

Now when you play your ♥6 as a squeeze card you have a problem. You are squeezing dummy, not East.

If you discard the ♦6 East will throw his ♦J, then sit back and wait for his ♠Q trick.

But if you discard dummy's ♠J instead, East will match that by throwing his ♠9, then sit back and wait for his ♦K trick.

Only by visualizing the ending and using the Vienna Coup can this hand be made.

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 9 8 4 3

♥ 10 8 6 2

♦ J 10 7 3

♣ —

♠ Q 7

♥ A 4

♦ Q 5 4

♣ A J 9 7 3 2



♠ J 10 6 5

♥ K Q J 7 5

♦ 9 2

♣ 8 4

♠ A 2

♥ 9 3

♦ A K 8 6

♣ K Q 10 6 5

West	North	East	South
	1 ♣	Pass	2 ♦
Pass	3 ♣	Pass	4 ♣
Pass	4 ♥	Pass	4 ♠
Pass	6 ♣		
All Pass			

6 ♣ by North

Lead: ♥ K

and discard dummy's ♠ 2 he is squeezed.

He can see that if he discards a ♦ dummy will be high, so he will probably throw the ♠ K in hopes that his partner holds the ♠ Q. But you have that card and you make the slam.

As an afterthought to this Deal, let us suppose you were playing 6NT rather than 6 ♣.

The only difference would be that to rectify the count you would have to hold up once on the opening ♥ K.

North is to play 6 ♣. East leads the ♥ K.

You have 11 top tricks and hope for a 3-3 ♦ split to give you one more. If they don't split you can hope that the defender with 4 ♦ s also holds the ♠ K and that a squeeze will be possible.

In case the squeeze becomes necessary you should rectify the count, so you win the first trick, pull trumps in two rounds, then give up a ♥ trick.

East takes the ♥ trick and plays the ♦ 9 which you win with your ♦ Q.

You now make the key play of taking dummy's ♠ A before running three rounds of ♣ s.

Unblocking the ♠ A to create a Threat out of your ♠ Q is the Vienna Coup.

As you see, West was able to find discards on your first three trump leads, but when you play the ♣ 7

Board 4

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9
 ♥ 10 5 3 2
 ♦ Q J 9 6 4 2
 ♣ 10 7

♠ A K Q 7 5 2

♥ 8 6 4

♦ 7 5

♣ 6 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 10 8 6
 ♥ 9 7
 ♦ 10 8 3
 ♣ J 9 8 4

♠ 4 3

♥ A K Q J

♦ A K

♣ A K Q 5 2

West	North	East	South
	2♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT	Pass	7NT
All Pass			
7NT by South			
Lead: ♦ Q			

Don't play ♠s yet!

Play your ♦ A. East must give up.

If he throws the ♣ J, you win. But if he throws a ♠ you also win. This is what is called a Win-Win bridge play.

North's 3NT rebid shows 6 ♠s headed by A K Q and nothing else. South is to play 7NT. West leads the ♦ Q.

Nice hand. You have 12 high card tricks and either a 3-2 ♠ split or a 3-3 ♣ split will land this Grand Slam. But even if neither suit splits nicely you can STILL make it if the same defender holds 4 cards in both suits; in that case you will squeeze for the thirteenth trick.

Win the ♦ K and (**IMPORTANT!**) test the ♣s first by playing ♣ A K Q. Darn. West discards a ♦ on the ♣ Q.

Alright, so East holds the ♣ Guard. You still need to exercise caution.

Play your 4 ♥ winner's next. West follows suit while East follows twice, then discards 2 ♦s.

Board 5

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 9 7 4 2
♥ J 4
♦ A 6 5 2
♣ 9 5 2

♠ A K Q J
♥ 9 5 3
♦ K Q
♣ 10 8 7 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 8 5 3
♥ Q 10 7 2
♦ J 10 8 4
♣ 6 3

♠ 10 6
♥ A K 8 6
♦ 9 7 3
♣ A K Q J

West	North	East	South
Pass	1NT	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♠	Pass	6NT
All Pass			
6NT by North			
Lead: ♦ J			

North is to play 6NT. East leads the ♦ J. West takes the ♦ A and returns the ♦ 2.

Your 4 ♠ tricks, 2 ♥ tricks, 1 ♦ trick and 4 ♣ tricks are very easy to find. But that's only 11, so where in the world can you possibly find number 12?

With all those high ♦ s falling on the first two tricks dummy's ♦ 9 has become a threat against East. If it should happen that East also holds the only ♥ stopper you can squeeze him in the red suits.

You are going to now run your black suit winners, but take the ♣ s first so you can be playing winners from your hand when you squeeze East.

On the last 2 ♣ s East discards a ♦ and a ♥.

Now come to your hand with the ♠ A and play the ♠ K Q.

You discard a small ♥ from dummy while East follows suit three times.

It is time.

Play your ♠ J and watch what East discards.

If he holds on to the ♦ 10 you will discard dummy's useless ♦ 9 and hope the ♥ s all fall under the ♥ A K.

If he discards the ♦ 10 then you throw dummy's small ♥ and dummy wins the last three tricks.